Horizon International Schools

Student Handbook

Academic Year

2026/2027

1. Welcome to Our School

Welcome to Horizon International Schools! Our school is a community where we focus on quality education, respect, and preparing you to be a global citizen. We expect every student to be:

- Creative

- Problem Solvers

- Global Citizens

- Excellent Communicator

This handbook explains your rights, responsibilities, and the rules you need to follow to help you succeed and stay safe.

2. Your Daily Schedule

- Arrival: You must be at school by 6:45 AM for the morning assembly.

- First Period: Classes start at 7:00 AM.

- End of Day: The school day ends at 12:45 PM.

- Punctuality: Being on time is a sign of respect for yourself and others. Repeated tardiness will result in disciplinary action.

3. Attendance & Absence

Your Responsibility:

- You must attend school every day.

- If you are absent, your parents **must call the school** to inform them.

- For extended illness, a medical report from an official hospital is required.

- Family emergencies or religious observances must be reported by your parents.

Excused vs. Unexcused:

- Excused Absence: Your parents notified the school (e.g., illness, family emergency, religious day).

- Unexcused Absence: Your parents did not notify the school. You will lose your right to make up work** or assessments.

Travel: If you are travelling, your parents must inform the school at least one day before departure.

4. School Uniform & Personal Appearance

Uniform Rules:

- You must wear the official school uniform every day.

- During winter, you may wear the official school jacket or a plain black or navy-blue hoodie (no logos).

- Shoes: Only athletic (sports) shoes** are permitted. Open-toe shoes are strictly prohibited.

- New Students: Until you receive your uniform, wear a loose, long-sleeved white shirt and loose black sports pants.

Personal Appearance (Prohibited):

- Hair styling/straightening

- Makeup

- Nail polish / Artificial nails

- Accessories (jewelry, etc.)

Eyeglasses:

- Students in Grades 1–3 must wear plastic safety glasses.

5. Mobile Phones & Smart Devices

- Strictly Prohibited: Smartphones, cameras, Bluetooth devices, internet-enabled devices, and smartwatches.

- Permitted: Basic mobile phones (no camera/internet). These must be handed to the Administration upon arrival** and collected at the end of the day.

- Violations:

  - First Offense: Phone confiscated. Parent must collect it at the end of the week.

  - Second Offense: Phone confiscated until the end of the academic year.

6. Academic Expectations

A. Daily Checklist

Your teacher will document your daily:

- Homework completion

- Participation in class

- Attendance and lateness

- Behavior

This record contributes to your participation grade.

B. Homework & Classwork

- Complete all assignments on time.

- If you are absent, you are responsible for collecting missed work from the teacher.

- Homework is collected and checked; late submissions affect your grade.

C. Quizzes

- Quizzes are usually not repeated.

- If you are absent (Grades 1–6), the grade is left blank and evaluated at term's end.

- If you are absent (Grades 7–12) without a medical excuse, you receive a zero (0).

- If you have an approved medical report, the grade is left blank.

D. Tests / Midterms

- Grades 1–3: Evaluated based on average performance; can receive full marks.

- Grades 4–6:One mark deducted for absence. If a medical report is submitted, the test is rescheduled.

- Grades 7–12: Without a medical excuse, you receive a zero (0). With an approved medical excuse, the test is rescheduled with a different version.

- Note: Travel is not an acceptable excuse.

E. Final Exams

- Exam schedules and coverage are announced in advance.

- During exams:

  - Arrive on time.

  - Use a blue ink pen (no pencils unless permitted).

  - Do not use correction fluid (White-Out).

  - No eating, drinking, or leaving the room during the exam.

F. Online Exams

- Teachers upload exams at the start of the week.

- Grades are recorded manually by the teacher within 2 working days.

- If you are absent, the grade is left blank and you will receive the same grade as your final exam (this is not disclosed to parents).

7. Grading & Feedback

- Quiz Grades: Uploaded within 48 hours (including Saturdays).

- Test Grades: Uploaded within 5 days (including Saturdays).

- Published: Grades are visible to your parents on the school platform immediately after the teacher uploads them.

- Parent Signature: You must have your parents sign test papers and return them to the teacher.

Participation Grade Deductions:

- Grades 1–9: Up to 5 marks deducted if parents are notified of lack of commitment.

- Grades 10–12: Up to 2 marks deducted if parents are notified.

8. Code of Conduct & Behavior

Guiding Principles:

- Treat everyone with respect and dignity.

- Use non-violent means to resolve conflict.

- Respect school property and the property of others.

- Follow all school rules and staff instructions.

What is Expected of You:

1. Show respect for yourself, others, and those in authority.

2. Come prepared, on time, and ready to learn.

3. Take responsibility for your own learning and actions.

4. Follow the rules and take responsibility for your actions.

Prohibited Actions (Zero Tolerance):

- Use of drugs, alcohol, or tobacco.

- Bullying, fighting, or harassment.

- Refusal to comply with teacher commands.

- Possession of a weapon or dangerous object.

- Vandalism.

- Swearing at a teacher or authority figure.

Discipline Process:

1. Teacher conference with student

2. Correction (private, kind, and firm)

3. Administration/Teacher conference

4. Administration/Student conference

5. Administration/Teacher/Student conference

6. Administration/Teacher/Parent conference

7. Detention

8. In-school suspension

9. Suspension from school

9. Safety & Health

Your Safety is Our Priority:

- Playgrounds are covered with rubber for injury protection.

- Fire hydrants, alarms, and fire systems are in every section.

- Science labs have safety equipment; chemicals are kept out of reach.

- Break times for lower grades are separated from upper grades to avoid overcrowding.

- A full first aid kit is available. If you are injured or sick, the supervisor will attend to you, and parents will be informed if you need hospital care.

- Classrooms, corridors, and bathrooms are cleaned and sterilized daily.

Your Responsibility:

- Be aware of safety procedures.

- Report any hazards or unsafe behavior to a teacher.

- Maintain personal cleanliness.

10. English Language Policy

- English is the primary language of communication inside and outside the classroom.

- You must use English during instruction, discussions, breaks, corridors, and activities.

- Exceptions: Arabic Language, Islamic Studies, and Saudi Social Studies classes may use Arabic.

11. Parent-Teacher Meetings

- Meetings are held to discuss your progress.

- Your teacher will:

  - Highlight your strengths first.

  - Provide constructive feedback on areas for improvement.

- Maintain a positive, solution-focused conversation.

- You are expected to be respectful and engaged.

12. Birthday Celebrations

-Grades 1–3: Celebrations are permitted only with prior approval from the Floor Supervisor and only during Art or PE classes.

- Grades 4–12: Birthday celebrations and parties are **strictly prohibited.

13. Activities

- Your participation in curricular and extracurricular activities is part of your development.

- Teachers will inform you of upcoming activities via the Weekly Plan.

- You are expected to participate, cooperate, and represent your school positively.

14. Communication

- The school platform (Pioneers) is the official channel for communication, assignments, and grades.

- Check the platform regularly.

- All official communication with parents and staff happens through the school, not social media.

15. Final Reminders

- Know the rules**—ignorance is not an excuse.
- Respect yourself and others.
- Be punctual, prepared, and positive.
- Take ownership of your learning.
- Follow safety and health guidelines.

We wish you a successful and rewarding academic year!